



Photograph Dr P T Jadhav, Karnataka

Each month *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 20th of this month.

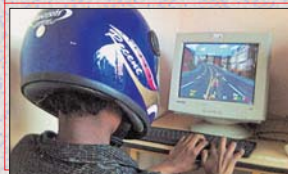
Beat That!

Digit Caption

"Tombs' Hardware!"

Last Month's Winner!

Vishal Gupta.
"Playing It Safe!"



E-mail your caption with the subject "Beat That", and your postal address, to beatthat@thinkdigit.com and win

SLQ Server 2005

by Brian Knight,
Ketan Pate
Wayne Snyder,
Jean-Claude Armand

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analysis company. So what was the winning idea? They made a market research and analysis system that real-world companies can use to analyse how users in the virtual world react to virtual brands, services and products. In plain English, that's a virtual business plan that will help companies make virtual business plans for virtual products or services. OK, maybe the first explanation was better...

Market Truths won first prize of 350,000 Linden

dollars (worth about \$1,300 in the real world). Judges felt that their real-world experience qualified them better than the other competitors. With an increasing number of companies looking to set up shop in the virtual world, it's only logical that they will need to have a plan and virtual market research details. Market Truths is already conducting research about brands and products, for which users who take part in the surveys are paid—in

Linden dollars, obviously.

One really has to wonder when the madness will end, if ever. It was crazy enough with people spending half their lives in *Second Life*; now we have companies taking this seriously and setting up virtual branches. We were kind of hoping that people would focus on real problems and pay a little more attention to the world that doesn't go away with power cuts, or not paying your ISP bill. What's next? *Second Life* failures turning to virtual drugs and begging on pixelated streets?

A POX ON OPEN SOURCE

Ballmer On Linux And Open Source

Once again, Steve Ballmer, Microsoft CEO, has threatened open source sellers. In February, in a meeting

with investors, Ballmer again took the opportunity to remind the world that open source "is not free," and reminded the world that the Linux OS violates some of the patents that Microsoft holds. Now we've been hearing these incoherent and disapproving noises emanating from Microsoft, with even rumours of MS suing companies that sell Open Source Software (OSS), but no one seems to know exactly what Microsoft has up their sleeve.

